

# The Rubâiyât of Ohow Dryyâm



Illustrated by Benj. Franklin  
[not of Philadelphia.]

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Title: The Rubaiyat of Ohow Dryyam

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Release date: November 5, 2007 [eBook #23338]

Most recently updated: November 20, 2007

Language: English

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THE  
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OHOW DRYYAM

*By* J. L. DUFF

*With Apologies to*  
OMAR



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# ***The Rubaiyat of Ohow Dryyam***

## **I**

Wail! for the Law has scattered into flight  
Those Drinks that were our sometime dear Delight;  
And still the Morals-tinkers plot and plan  
New, sterner, stricter Statutes to indite.

## **II**

After the phantom of our Freedom died  
Methought a Voice within the Tavern cried:  
“Drink coffee, Lads, for that is all that’s left  
Since our Land of the Free is washed—and dried.”



*And still the Morals-tinkers plot and plan  
New, sterner, stricter Statutes to indite.*

---

### III

The Haigs indeed are gone, and on the Nose  
That bourgeoned once with color of the rose  
    A deathly Pallor sits, while down the lane  
Where once strode Johnny Walker—Water goes.

### IV

Come, fill the Cup, and in the Coffee-house  
We'll learn a new and temperate Carouse—  
    The Bird of Time flies with a steadier wing  
But roosts with sleepless Eye—a Coffee Souse!

### V

Each morn a thousand Recipes, you say—  
Yes, but where match the beer of Yesterday?  
    And those Spring Months that used to bring the Bock  
Seem very long ago and far away.



*The Bird of Time flies with a steadier wing  
But roosts with sleepless Eye—a Coffee Souse!*

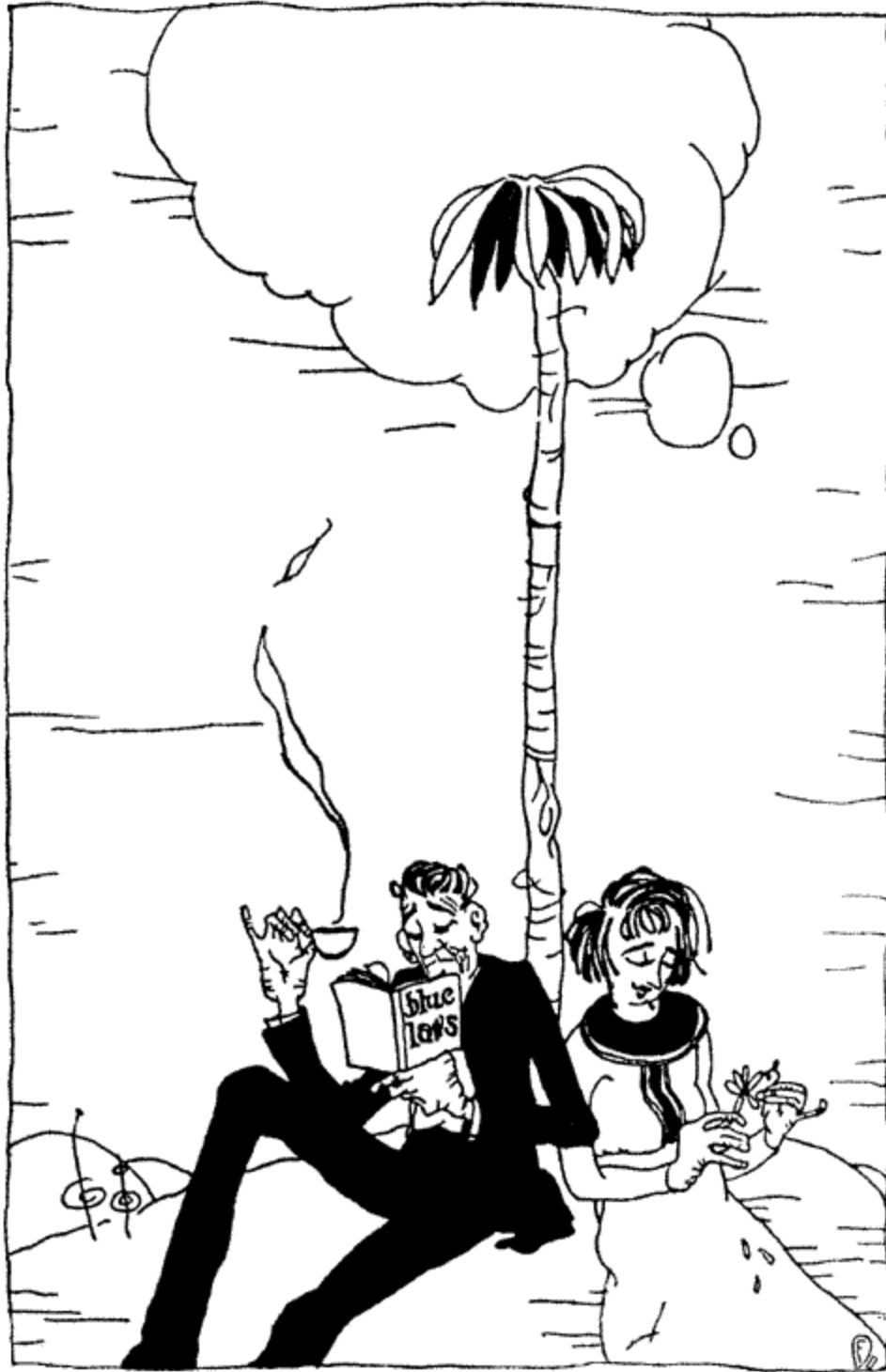
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## VI

A Book of Blue Laws underneath the Bough,  
A pot of Tea, a piece of Toast,—and Thou  
Beside me sighing in the Wilderness—  
Wilderness? It's Desert, Sister, now.

## VII

Some for a Sunday without Taint, and Some  
Sigh for Inebriate Paradise to come,  
While Moonshine takes the Cash (no Credit goes)  
And real old Stuff demands a Premium.



*A Book of Blue Laws underneath the Bough,  
A pot of Tea, a piece of Toast,—and Thou ...*

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## VIII

The Scanty Stock we set our hearts upon  
Still dwindles and declines until anon,  
    Like Snow upon the Desert's dusty Face,  
It lights us for an hour and then—is gone.

## IX

Ah, my Beloved, fill the Cup that clears  
TODAY of past Regrets and future Fears—  
    Tomorrow!—Why, Tomorrow I may be  
In Canada or Scotland or Algiers!

## X

Yes, make the most of what we still may spend;  
The last Drop's lingering Taste may yet transcend  
    Anticipation's Bliss—though we are left  
Sans Wine, Sans Song, Sans Singer, and—Sans End.



*The Scanty Stock we set our hearts upon ...*

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## XI

Alike for those who for the Drouth prepared  
And those who, like myself, more poorly fared,  
    Fond Memory weaves Roseate Shrouds to dress  
Departed Spirits we have loved—and shared.

## XII

Myself when young did eagerly frequent  
The gilded Bar, and all my Lucre spent  
    For bottled Joyousness, but evermore  
Came out less steadily than in I went.

## XIII

The legal Finger writes; and having writ,  
Moves on—and neither Thirst nor Wit  
    Has lured it back to cancel half a line  
To give a Man excuse for being lit.



*Myself when young did eagerly frequent  
The gilded Bar ...*

---

## XIV

And Bill the Bootlegger—the Infidel!—  
When He takes my last Cent for just a Smell  
    Of Hooch, I wonder what Bootleggers buy  
One half so precious as the Stuff they sell.

## XV

Oh Bill, Who dost with White Mule and with Gin  
Beset the Road I am to Wander in,  
    If I am garnered of the Law, wilt Thou,  
All piously, Impute my Fall to Sin?



*And Bill the Bootlegger—the Infidel!—*

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## XVI

Yon rising Moon that looks for us again—  
How oft hereafter will she wax and wane;  
    But, Oh, how oft before we have beheld  
Six Moons arise—who now seek *Two* in vain.

## XVII

And when Thyself at last shall come to trip  
Down that dim Dock where Charon loads his Ship,  
    I'll meet Thee on the other Wharf if Thou  
Wilt promise to have Something on thy Hip.



*But, Oh, how oft before we have beheld  
Six Moons arise ...*

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